

ELITE DANGEROUS OPERATIONS · ENGINEERING · COMMANDER

ED-Frame

USER MANUAL

[Operation](#) · [Privacy](#) · [Data flows](#) · [Unlock Guide](#)

VERSION

1.5.5

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CMDR Forcer · GNU General Public License v3.0

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1. Purpose and core principles

ED-Frame is a local Engineering and Commander companion for Elite Dangerous. It combines Frontier Journal events, related JSON snapshots, bundled reference catalogs and optional community services.

- Journal-first: Commander state and progress come from local Journal evidence and related snapshots.
- Offline-capable: Engineering catalogs, material data, Engineer chains and reference coordinates are bundled.
- Opt-in networking: Frontier Companion API, INARA, EDDN upload, EDDN Relay and Spansh actions are separately visible and controlled.
- Honest evidence: Unknown history remains **PENDING** or **UNKNOWN**; the application does not turn a plausible assumption into a fact.
- State-based inventory: Deltas are applied only to a known full baseline. A later authoritative snapshot replaces interim calculations.
- Physical-slot planning: A plan remains attached to a ship's physical module slot, so identical modules are not confused.
- Observed, planned and predicted stay separate: ED-Frame distinguishes Journal-confirmed facts from planned work and predictions.

System requirements

Component	Requirement or purpose
Windows	Windows 10 or 11; standard browser; optional tray and startup operation
Portable release	ED-Frame.exe with the adjacent _internal folder
Source run	Python 3 with the packages from requirements.txt ; START_APP.bat checks the runtime
Elite Dangerous	Local access to Journal files and snapshot JSON files
Internet	Only for optional Frontier CAPI, INARA, EDDN or Spansh features

2. Quick start

- 1 Start the app. For the portable release, run **ED-Frame.exe**. From source, run **START_APP.bat**; use **INSTALL_REQUIREMENTS.bat** once if packages are missing.
- 2 Check the Journal folder. Under Settings, verify the Journal directory. Journal Auto reads new evidence.
- 3 Select a ship and plan. Under Engineering, select a ship, physical module slot, blueprint, grade and optional experimental effect.
- 4 Pin the plan. Add it to the Wishlist. ED-Frame calculates demand, inventory and protected surplus.
- 5 Follow Operations. Commander Operations shows the next useful action, Engineer target, missing materials and trader guidance.
- 6 Enable networking deliberately. Configure Frontier CAPI, INARA, EDDN or Spansh separately under Settings > Connections. No service is contacted without the relevant action or consent.

3. Navigation and main areas

Area	Purpose
Operations	Prioritised next action, material demand, Engineer and trader targets, route and activity
Engineering	Ship, physical slot, module, blueprint, grade, experimental effect and build import/export
Wishlist	Multiple planned modules, priority, craft progress and combined material demand
Engineers	Capability index, Unlock Guide and Human or Guardian Technology Broker unlocks
Materials	Raw, Manufactured and Encoded inventory, demand, protected stock and sources
Mining Finder	Commodity, mining method, distance, reserve quality and evidence-based targets
State Finds	Local and optional EDDN evidence for HGE, BGS and signal hunting
Powerplay	Journal-observed pledge, rank, merits, salary, cargo and system state
CMDR	Ranks, reputation, credits, assets, current ship, fleet and squadron
Logbook	Searchable local history, sessions and notes
Exobiology	Biological survey targets, scan progress, values and sample-distance guidance
Settings	Appearance, Journal, Connections, Diagnostics, tray and local-data controls

Navigation and CMDR cards can be reordered by drag-and-drop and are stored locally. Search, Ko-fi and About remain fixed. The interface is available in English, German, Spanish and French. Six themes, UI scaling, reduced motion and optional enhanced visuals are available in Settings.

Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Function
Ctrl+K	Global search
Ctrl+R	Reload Journal and fleet
Ctrl+Shift+J	Pause or resume Journal Auto
F1	Keyboard overview
Alt+1 to Alt+9	Open primary areas directly

4. Data flow at a glance

Direction	Service or source	What happens	Default
Local -> ED-Frame	Elite Journal	Game events, location, materials, fleet, ranks, missions and Engineering	Active
Local -> ED-Frame	Snapshot JSON	Cargo, Market, Outfitting, Shipyard, NavRoute, Modules and Status	Event-driven
ED-Frame -> INARA	INARA API	Approved personal Commander state in whitelisted event types	Off
ED-Frame -> EDDN	EDDN Gateway	Public galaxy and station data in validated schemas	Off
EDDN -> ED-Frame	EDDN Relay	Public live messages for State Finds	Off
Frontier -> ED-Frame	Frontier Companion API	Consented profile snapshot for credits and active ship	Off
Spansh -> ED-Frame	Station Search	Trader and broker locations and metadata	Manual

ED-Frame filters, correlates and persists local state. Newer Journal values remain authoritative when optional Frontier profile data is present. Spansh receives targeted search filters and reference coordinates only after a user action; Commander inventory and Journal history are not uploaded to Spansh.

5. Local sources and storage

Frontier Journal

Journal files are monitored by filename, modification time and size. Persistent cursors process new lines once and detect later growth in recently active files.

Snapshot files

File	Use
Cargo.json	Full cargo baseline and later purchase, sale, transfer and collection deltas
Market.json	Market and commodity snapshot for EDDN commodity/3
Outfitting.json	Station modules for outfitting/3 , with v2 fallback for incomplete sources
Shipyard.json	Station ships for shipyard/2
NavRoute.json	Navigation route for navroute/1
ModulesInfo.json and Loadout	Modules, Engineering and ship state
Status.json	Supplementary local status information

Local profile directory

Writable state is isolated under **%LOCALAPPDATA%\ED-Frame\profile-....** It includes UI settings, Wishlist and ship plans, notes, Journal cursors, receipts, queues, caches and optional service configuration. On an upgrade to the ED-Frame name, compatible settings are copied into the new data directory while the previous directory is retained as a safety net.

API keys, Commander configuration and consent remain local. Frontier OAuth tokens are encrypted for the current Windows account. Close ED-Frame before backing up or removing a profile directory.

6. Engineering, Wishlist and materials

Engineering

- Select any known fleet ship without switching ships in-game.
- Choose an actual Core Internal, Optional Internal, Hardpoint or Utility slot.
- Select a blueprint, target grade and optional experimental effect from the bundled catalog.
- Import ED-Frame, EDSY/SLEF or Coriolis builds through hull-and-slot validation. Conflicts are shown before replacement.
- Pinning creates a plan; exact duplicates are not created twice.

Wishlist and fair share

The Wishlist aggregates requirements across ships and modules. Allocation respects priorities, inventory, protected stock and fair-share rules, so one plan cannot consume another plan's protected materials. Journal-confirmed crafts advance the correct physical slot; ambiguous or unrelated craft events are surfaced for review.

Material details

For each material, ED-Frame shows inventory, capacity, demand, estimated quantities, protected stock, safe surplus, verified sources and possible trader exchanges. A later full Materials snapshot replaces delta-derived interim state and prevents double counting.

7. Engineer Unlock Guide

- 1 Open Engineers and activate Unlock Guide.
- 2 Select an Engineer. System, prerequisite and current progress are loaded.
- 3 Read the ordered chain: prerequisite, meeting, mission or contribution, permit or visit, then unlock.
- 4 Follow the next verifiable action. COPY SYSTEM copies a supported destination; cargo and material requirements are checked against local inventory.
- 5 Reload the Journal or leave Journal Auto enabled. New evidence is evaluated again.

Statuses distinguish supported next steps from missing evidence and unmet prerequisites. Depending on the view, these appear as **READY**, **ACTIVE**, **PENDING**, **BLOCKED** or **LOCKED**.

Evidence includes **EngineerProgress**, **EngineerContribution**, accepted and completed missions, **FSDJump**, **Location**, **Docked**, ranks, promotions, permits and material or cargo state. A step is never marked complete only because it seems plausible.

8. Engineers, Technology Brokers, State Finds and Logbook

Engineer overview

Known Engineers are grouped by access state and show rank progress, location and capabilities. Search and filters separate unlocked, ready, pending and locked entries. Portraits and descriptions are local assets; access state comes from Journal evidence.

Technology Brokers

Human and Guardian unlocks are tracked as one-time recipes against local inventory and Journal evidence. Broker locations can be supplemented by Spansh, but an external location result does not replace Journal confirmation.

State Finds

State Finds combines local Journal observations with optional EDDN Relay messages. Evidence classes distinguish **LOCAL LIVE**, **LOCAL ENTERED**, **EDDN LIVE**, **RECENT REPORT** and weaker BGS candidates. Time-sensitive signals expire.

Logbook

The Logbook keeps a bounded, searchable local history grouped by travel, docking, Engineering, materials, station services, progress and session. Personal notes remain local, are limited to 500 characters and are never sent to INARA or EDDN.

9. CMDR overview

The CMDR workspace presents ranks, reputation, finances, fleet and the current ship without inventing values that were not observed.

- Overview: eight rank tracks, major-faction reputation, known minor factions, financial snapshots, current ship and squadron.
- Credits: current-session and selectable time ranges, net change, average credits per hour and exact observed timestamps. Gaps are not interpolated as facts.
- Fleet: ship value, rebuy and location for current, stored, remote or transferring ships. The same fleet powers physical-slot Engineering.
- Powerplay: local Journal evidence for pledged leader, pledge duration, rank, merits, salary, cargo and observed system state.
- Exobiology: FSS, DSS and organic-scan evidence becomes survey targets, carried value, session value, genus progress and sample-distance guidance.

Credits come from consolidated Journal anchors; assets come from **Statistics**. Optional Frontier CAPI can supplement credits and the active ship, but newer Journal values remain authoritative. Optional synchronization of related categories does not mean the CMDR page is loaded from INARA.

10. Connections and consent

Control	Effect
Frontier CAPI consent	Allows Frontier login and a profile snapshot for credits and active ship
INARA consent	Allows contact with the INARA API; requires API key and Commander name
INARA auto sync	Allows automatic batch synchronization after relevant Journal changes
EDDN consent	Allows contact with the EDDN network
EDDN upload	Sends supported new public Journal and station data
EDDN listener	Receives public Relay data for State Finds; independent of upload
Spansh update	Manually refreshes trader or broker catalog results

Frontier authorization uses PKCE OAuth with no client secret. Tokens are encrypted for the current Windows account and are not written to diagnostics. Disconnecting or disabling a service prevents new relevant requests; durable pending work follows the documented queue and retry rules.

11. INARA - data sent

INARA is a personal Commander service. ED-Frame sends only approved Live Journal data to <https://inara.cz/inapi/v1/>. The request identifies the registered app and version, API key, Commander name and, when available, Frontier ID.

Category	Transmitted state
Inventory	Materials, cargo and Odyssey items; reset and full snapshot events
Travel	Location, docking, FSD or carrier jump and landing
Ranks	Pilot, Engineer and Powerplay rank including merits
Reputation	Major and minor factions
Finances	Consolidated credits and game statistics
Fleet	Add, delete or set ship; loadout, transfer and stored modules
Odyssey loadouts	Set, update or delete suit loadout
Missions and permits	Active, completed, failed or abandoned missions; confirmed permits
Combat	Death, kill, interdiction and escape
Community Goals	Personal progress

ED-Frame does not forward the complete Journal. Only whitelisted Live events with required fields enter a batch. Material, cargo, ShipLocker and module-storage deltas require a known full baseline. Beta, Alpha, Test and Legacy sessions are rejected by the Live-data guard.

12. INARA - reads, timing and safeguards

Reads

API event	Purpose	Caching
<code>getCommanderProfile</code>	Commander profile and supplementary profile data	Local; not reloaded for every view
<code>getCommunityGoalsRecent</code>	Current Community Goals	Long interval

Send cycle

Rule	Implemented value
Collection window	45 seconds after a recognised change
Automatic minimum interval	300 seconds between automatic sends; persisted across restart
Hard limit	At most 2 requests per minute
Batch size	1 to 50 events per request
Deduplication	SHA-256 fingerprints and successful receipts
Retry	Exponential backoff from 60 to 900 seconds; 3,700-second rate-limit cooldown
Queue limit	2,000 pending events; overflow is visibly reported

INARA is not a general Journal relay. ED-Frame groups domain changes and does not resend a successfully confirmed, unchanged event.

13. EDDN - public community data

EDDN is a public real-time network for galaxy and station data. ED-Frame validates and compresses supported messages before sending them to the live gateway.

The EDDN header contains a random local **uploaderID**, registered software name and version, and game version or build - not the Commander name. Private fields such as Commander, FID, PrivateGroup, Multicrew, personal reputation and squadron faction are removed. Fields ending in **_Localised** are excluded.

Gateway upload and ZeroMQ Relay listening are independent. Relay messages are validated and used only as transient public evidence.

14. EDDN - supported data

Supported groups cover **journal/1**, settlement approach, codex, docking results, Fleet Carrier materials, FSS events, nav beacon and route, barycentre, organic scans, **commodity/3**, **outfitting/3** with v2 fallback, and **shipyard/2**.

scanorganic/1 sends schema-compliant Log and Sample observations; Analyse is excluded according to the schema rule. **blackmarket/1** and **fcmaterials_capi/1** remain intentionally unsupported because ED-Frame does not obtain the required Frontier market data for those EDDN schemas.

Received Relay messages are zlib-decompressed, parsed as JSON and normalized. Relevant FSS or BGS signals may feed State Finds. The EDDN live service is a message stream, not a permanent archive.

15. Spansh - data retrieved

ED-Frame sends targeted station-search filters and reference coordinates to <https://www.spansh.co.uk/api/stations/search> only after a user action.

Request part	Purpose
reference_coords	Distance sorting from the current or selected system
services = Material Trader	Restricts results to material traders
material_trader	Raw, Manufactured or Encoded
sort = distance asc	Nearest results first
size and page	Bounded result set, not a mass download

ED-Frame uses system and station name, Market ID, coordinates, distance, arrival distance, large-pad and planetary properties, trader type and update time. Invalid or incomplete replies are rejected. Bundled catalogs remain available offline. No Commander inventory, Journal series or automatic background telemetry is sent to Spansh.

16. External-service privacy matrix

Service	Sent	Retrieved	Identifier	Activation
Frontier CAPI	OAuth requests	Credits and active ship profile snapshot	Frontier account token, encrypted locally	Explicit consent and login
INARA	Personal Commander state in 36 whitelist types	Commander profile and current Community Goals	API key, Commander name, optional Frontier ID	Consent; Auto separate
EDDN Gateway	Public galaxy and station data	Gateway receipt	Random uploaderID , app and game version	Consent plus Upload
EDDN Relay	Nothing	Public live messages	Network connection	Consent plus Listener
Spansh	Search filters and reference coordinates	Station and trader results	User-Agent and app version	Manual action
GitHub and Ko-fi	No app telemetry	Browser page after a click	Browser decides	Explicit click

ED-Frame is not designed to upload an unfiltered Journal, Logbook notes, UI order, local Wishlist comments, INARA keys, EDDN Commander or private-group fields, or automatic Spansh telemetry.

17. Offline operation, failures and queues

Situation	Behaviour
DNS, connection or timeout	Error is caught and shown; the app remains usable; retry uses backoff
HTTP 500 or 503	Retryable service failure; queue is retained
Invalid JSON or HTML response	Explicit response diagnostic; no false success
EDDN schema error 400, 413 or 426	Terminal schema error with guidance; not retried forever
Long offline period	Persistent queue up to its visible limit
App restart	Queues, cursors, receipts, rate-limit state and INARA timing are restored

A green receipt confirms gateway or API acceptance, not necessarily immediate display on an external website. Settings > Diagnostics shows Journal watcher health, renderer, service pipelines, the local log and crash reports. COPY REPORT creates a sanitized diagnostic report.

18. Frequently asked questions and troubleshooting

Problem	Check or solution
INARA timestamp does not change	Confirm that a relevant inventory-changing event occurred. Unchanged state is intentionally deduplicated.
Material trade or craft is not visible	A full Materials snapshot must establish the baseline first; then check Journal Auto and INARA Auto.
EDDN shows no uploads	Check consent, Upload and whether the event has a supported public schema.
State Finds is empty	Enable the Listener, check the network and wait for relevant FSS or BGS messages; local evidence appears only from your own play.
Unlock remains PENDING	Historical Journal evidence is missing. Perform the next documented action and let the Journal update the state.
Spansh finds no trader	Check reference coordinates, network and filters. The offline catalog remains usable.
Frontier login fails	Confirm consent and that the registered Frontier client is active. Tokens remain local and encrypted.
UI is too large or small	Set UI Scale between 100% and 150%; 100% is a true factor of 1.0.
App does not fully close	With tray mode enabled, choose Exit ED-Frame from the tray menu.

Appendix A. Complete INARA upload whitelist

No.	Event	No.	Event
1	addCommanderCombatDeath	19	setCommanderInventory
2	addCommanderCombatInterdicted	20	setCommanderInventoryCargo
3	addCommanderCombatInterdiction	21	setCommanderInventoryMaterials
4	addCommanderCombatInterdictionEscape	22	setCommanderMissionAbandoned
5	addCommanderCombatKill	23	setCommanderMissionCompleted
6	addCommanderMission	24	setCommanderMissionFailed
7	addCommanderPermit	25	setCommanderRankEngineer
8	addCommanderShip	26	setCommanderRankPilot
9	addCommanderTravelCarrierJump	27	setCommanderRankPower
10	addCommanderTravelDock	28	setCommanderReputationMajorFaction
11	addCommanderTravelFSDJump	29	setCommanderReputationMinorFaction
12	addCommanderTravelLand	30	setCommanderShip
13	delCommanderShip	31	setCommanderShipLoadout
14	delCommanderSuitLoadout	32	setCommanderShipTransfer
15	resetCommanderInventory	33	setCommanderStorageModules
16	setCommanderCommunityGoalProgress	34	setCommanderSuitLoadout
17	setCommanderCredits	35	setCommanderTravelLocation
18	setCommanderGameStatistics	36	updateCommanderSuitLoadout

Additional cached read events are **getCommanderProfile** and **getCommunityGoalsRecent**. They are not part of the automatic upload whitelist.

Appendix B. Complete EDDN schema list

No.	Schema	No.	Schema
1	approachsettlement/1	10	fssignaldiscovered/1
2	codexentry/1	11	journal/1
3	commodity/3	12	navbeaconscan/1
4	dockingdenied/1	13	navroute/1
5	dockinggranted/1	14	outfitting/2
6	fcmaterials_journal/1	15	outfitting/3
7	fssallbodiesfound/1	16	scanbarycentre/1
8	fssbodysignals/1	17	scanorganic/1
9	fssdiscoveryscan/1	18	shipyard/2

CAPi-only and intentionally not implemented for EDDN upload: **blackmarket/1** and **fcmaterials_capi/1**.

Appendix C. Sources, license and scope

Source	URL	Purpose
ED-Frame source	GitHub repository	Implemented feature and privacy state for version 1.5.5
INARA API	API documentation and developer guide	Event format, required fields, batching and responses
EDDN	Repository and live schemas	Network principles and canonical schemas
Spansh	spansh.co.uk	Station and galaxy reference service

ED-Frame is licensed under the GNU General Public License v3.0. The complete license text is included as **LICENSE** in the project. This manual describes version 1.5.5 and may become outdated after later API, schema or UI changes.

Thanks to contributors, testers, bug reporters, translators and the Elite Dangerous community, and to EDCD/EDDN, INARA and Spansh for documentation, services and community resources.

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